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BRITISH EMBASSY,
TOKYO.

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27th January, 1953.

Dear Rob,

For some time past I have felt that we should try to know more about what is going on between Japan and the Nationalist Government in Formosa. My own feeling is that, while the Japanese were at first very angry at being forced to conclude a treaty with Chiang Kai-shek, they reconciled themselves with the situation rather rapidly, and it may be that through a closer association with the existing régime in Formosa they may hope once again to acquire a measure of influence in that island, if no more. Thus I can see why the Japanese should be friendly with Chiang Kai-shek, but I am not equally clear why Chiang Kai-shek should be so friendly with the Japanese.

It occurs to me in this connection that it might be useful if Jacobs-Larkcom could come here on a visit, so that we could compare notes. We might also be able to give him some indication of what to look for on the Japanese side. There should be no difficulty in his paying a visit to Japan, though frequent visits would no doubt give rise to speculation and be difficult to explain away. But once a year at any rate it might seem reasonable for him to come to Japan ostensibly on short local leave, in the course of which it would seem natural for him to stay in the Embassy for a few days.

I shall be grateful if you will let me know whether you think there is anything in this idea, and if so whether such a visit can be arranged.

Yours ever,

Bill Hemming

R.H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,
Foreign Office.

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